

DEVELOPMENT FINANCE CORPORATION

Bliss Parade, City of Belmopan, Cayo District, Belize

REQUEST FOR PROPOSALS

FOR

WEBSITE REDEVELOPMENT AND APPLICATION INTAKE SYSTEM

Reference: RFP MKT-2026-001

Prepared by:

Development Finance Corporation (DFC)

February 27 2026

Table of Contents

Contents

Table of Contents i

1. Introduction 1

 1.1 Company Profile..... 1

 1.2 Background and Purpose 1

2. Submission Guidelines and Requirements..... 3

 2.1 Bidder Qualifications 3

 2.2 Non-Disclosure Agreement 3

 2.3 Submission Deadline..... 3

3. General Description 4

4. Scope of Work 5

 4.1 Public Website Functional Scope 5

 4.1.1 Corporate Information 5

 4.1.2 Loan Products..... 5

 4.1.3 General Features 5

 4.2 Loan Application Workflow 5

 4.2.1 Public Application Submission 5

 4.2.2 Branch Review and Triage 6

 4.2.3 Application Package Generation 6

 4.2.4 Supervisor Workflow 7

 4.2.5 Agent View..... 7

 4.3 Internal Staff Portal — General Requirements..... 7

 4.4 Foreclosures Module 7

 Public View 7

 Staff Management 7

 4.5 Staff Vacancies Module..... 8

 Public View 8

 Staff Management 8

 4.6 Data Migration..... 8

5. Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) 9

6. Technical Scope 11

 6.1 Architecture Requirements 11

 6.2 Usability Requirements..... 11

 6.3 Security Requirements 11

7. Methodology 13

8. Deliverables 14

9. Warranty Period..... 15

10. Support and Maintenance 16

11. References and Portfolio..... 17

12. Proposal Format 18

1. Introduction

1.1 Company Profile

The Development Finance Corporation (DFC) is Belize's only development bank and a key instrument in the Government of Belize's economic development strategy. Established to provide financing and support services for the long-term sustainable development of Belizean businesses and individuals, DFC serves clients across all districts of Belize through its headquarters in Belmopan and five branch offices.

DFC offers a comprehensive range of loan products, including:

- Housing and home improvement loans (100% Home Loans, We Serve Home Loans for Public Officers, Starter Homes)
- Small and commercial business loans (including the EMPOWERED programme for women and young men)
- Student and education loans
- Sustainable energy and renewable energy loans
- Tourism, agriculture, livestock, artisanal fishing, and commercial fishing loans
- Construction, infrastructure, real estate development, and manufacturing loans

DFC operates from six locations across Belize:

Branch	Location	Contact
Headquarters	Bliss Parade, City of Belmopan, Cayo District	+501-822-2360
Belize City	1440 Coney Drive, Belize City, Belize District	+501-223-3605
Orange Walk	47 Progress Street, Orange Walk Town	+501-322-2153
San Pedro	Island Plaza, Barrier Reef Drive, San Pedro Town	+501-226-2144
Dangriga	111 Saint Vincent Street, Dangriga Town	+501-522-3041
Corozal	Fourth Avenue 3rd St., Corozal Town	+501-422-3191

1.2 Background and Purpose

DFC's current public website is built on a legacy WordPress platform. While functional, the platform no longer adequately supports the Corporation's operational, security, and workflow requirements. Specific deficiencies include:

- Lack of a structured, branch-aware loan application intake workflow
- No internal staff portal for application triage, routing, and package generation
- Inadequate role-based access controls for internal users

- Limited maintainability and security posture for a financial institution
- No systematic management of the foreclosures and staff vacancy content modules

DFC is seeking a qualified vendor to design and develop a modern, web-based application to replace the existing WordPress site. The selected vendor will be responsible for the full design, development, testing, and handover of the solution. Hosting, infrastructure management, and ongoing operational maintenance will be performed entirely by DFC's internal Information Technology team following handover.

2. Submission Guidelines and Requirements

2.1 Bidder Qualifications

Only qualified development firms meeting the following criteria will be considered:

- Demonstrated experience building and delivering bespoke web applications
- At least two (2) prior projects involving secure document upload, management, and retrieval
- Demonstrated experience implementing role-based access control (RBAC) in web applications
- Prior experience working in financial services, government, or other regulated industries is preferred
- Proficiency with modern web-development frameworks or equivalent.
- Experience with agile/SCRUM development methodology.
- Demonstrable application of web security best practices.
- Portfolio of at least two (2) similar back-office workflow or application intake systems.

2.2 Non-Disclosure Agreement

All bidding parties will be required to sign and return a Confidentiality and Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) before DFC shares detailed operational documentation, workflow specifications, or data structure information. Given the sensitive nature of loan applicant data and DFC's obligations as a financial institution, strict confidentiality is required throughout the procurement process.

The bidding party and all officers, employees, agents, advisors, and partners must comply with the requirements of the NDA for the duration of the procurement process and beyond.

2.3 Submission Deadline

All proposals must be submitted electronically to bids@dfcbelize.org on or before March 31, 2026.

Please include the subject line: "BID RFP MKT-2026-001 Website Redevelopment and Application Intake System"

Where file size prohibits email submission, DFC will arrange an alternative secure transfer method upon request. Submissions received after the published deadline will not be eligible for consideration.

Technical or clarification queries must be submitted to bids@dfcbelize.org no later than March 13, 2026. Responses will be provided within three (3) business days.

3. General Description

This project requires the complete redevelopment of DFC's public-facing website with support for internal web application for loan application intake, triage, and routing. The solution consists of three primary components:

- A public-facing website providing corporate information, loan product details, online loan inquiry submission, foreclosure listings, and staff vacancies.
- An internal staff portal enabling branch users, supervisors, and agents to manage the loan application lifecycle from intake through to CRM handoff.
- A content management capability allowing designated staff to manage foreclosure listings, vacancy postings, and other publishable content.

The solution will not replace DFC's existing CRM or Loan Management System. Once an application has been reviewed, packaged, and assigned by a supervisor, the agent will manually create the loan application in the CRM. The website system serves as the intake, triage, and routing layer only.

The vendor is responsible for design, development, testing, data migration, documentation, and knowledge transfer. Upon final acceptance, full ownership of all source code, assets, and intellectual property transfers to DFC. DFC will host, deploy, and maintain the system internally.

4. Scope of Work

4.1 Public Website Functional Scope

The public-facing website shall include at minimum the following:

4.1.1 Corporate Information

- About DFC: mission, vision, values, and objectives
- Board of Directors: names, photographs, and biographies
- Exec Management team
- Corporate documents: downloadable annual reports, policies, and publications
- Partners and affiliates section
- DFC news and announcements
- Social media links

4.1.2 Loan Products

A dedicated section for each DFC loan product, including:

- Housing loans (100% Home Loans, We Serve, Starter Homes)
- Small and commercial business loans (including EMPOWERED programme)
- Student and education loans
- Sustainable and renewable energy loans
- Tourism, agriculture, livestock, fishing, construction, and infrastructure loans

Each product page shall include eligibility information, interest rates, required documents, and a clear call-to-action linking to the loan inquiry form.

4.1.3 General Features

- Responsive design (desktop, tablet, mobile) supporting Chrome, Edge, Safari, and Firefox
- Site-wide search functionality
- SEO optimisation including metadata management and redirect mapping from existing URLs
- FAQ section
- Contact forms per branch with branch location details
- Newsletter subscription capability
- Terms and conditions and privacy policy pages
- Download Centre for loan brochures, forms, and reports

4.2 Loan Application Workflow

4.2.1 Public Application Submission

The system shall allow members of the public to submit a loan inquiry online. The submission form shall:

- Collect all required applicant information (personal details, loan type, amount requested, employment details, and other fields to be defined during inception)
- Allow applicants to select the DFC branch they wish to apply through
- Allow secure upload of supporting documents (accepted file types and size limits to be confirmed during inception)
- Validate all required fields prior to submission
- Generate a unique application reference number upon successful submission
- Send an automated confirmation email to the applicant containing the reference number and a summary of the submission
- Send an automated notification email to the designated inbox of the selected branch
- Assign an initial status of Submitted to the application

4.2.2 Branch Review and Triage

Branch users shall have access to a queue of applications submitted to their assigned branch. Branch users shall be able to:

- View all applications assigned to their branch, filtered by status
- Review all application details and uploaded documents
- Add internal notes to the application record
- Upload additional documents on behalf of the applicant
- Update the application status through the defined workflow stages
- Send an email notification to the applicant requesting missing or additional information
- Generate and download the application package (see Section 4.2.3)
- Forward a secure link to the application package to the reporting supervisor
- View the complete audit history of all actions taken on the application

Application statuses shall include at minimum:

- Submitted
- Pending Applicant Information
- Ready for Packaging
- Sent to Supervisor
- Assigned to Agent
- Closed

All status transitions must be logged with the user ID, timestamp, and optional notes.

4.2.3 Application Package Generation

The system shall provide the ability to compile a downloadable application package. This package shall consist of:

- A system-generated PDF summary of all application data, formatted to DFC's requirements (template to be confirmed during inception)
- All documents uploaded during and after submission, compiled into a structured ZIP archive with a defined folder and file naming convention

The package shall be downloadable via a secure, time-limited signed link. All package generation and download events shall be logged in the application audit trail.

4.2.4 Supervisor Workflow

Reporting supervisors shall be able to:

- View all applications forwarded to them from branch staff
- Assign an application to a specific agent
- Update the application status to reflect assignment
- Track the full application lifecycle within the system

Note: Supervisor assignment is performed within the portal. The supervisor may also receive the application package via email, but all assignment actions must be recorded in the system.

4.2.5 Agent View

Agents shall be able to:

- View applications assigned to them by a supervisor
- Update application status to reflect CRM entry and final disposition
- Add notes to the application record

The agent's work in the external CRM is out of scope for this system. The portal serves only to track and confirm handoff.

4.3 Internal Staff Portal — General Requirements

The internal portal shall be accessible only to authenticated users. All sessions must be protected and time-limited. The portal must support concurrent access by approximately 75 internal users across all branches and the Belmopan headquarters.

The portal must include a dashboard providing each user with a summary view relevant to their role: pending applications, recently updated items, and any items requiring their action.

4.4 Foreclosures Module

The system shall provide a public-facing foreclosures section and a staff-managed backend for content administration. Requirements include:

Public View

- Searchable and filterable listings (by district/location and property/item type)
- Each listing to include: title, description, images (multiple per listing), downloadable documents, price, location, and status
- Status options: Available, Under Offer, Sold, Archived
- Link to information on how to purchase foreclosed properties
- Link to DFC Public Auction notices

Staff Management

- Designated content staff can create, edit, publish, unpublish, and archive listings
- Image and document upload per listing

- Status management
- Expiry or archiving rules to be confirmed during inception

4.5 Staff Vacancies Module

The system shall provide a public-facing careers/vacancies section and a staff-managed backend. Requirements include:

Public View

- List of active job postings with title, department, location, closing date, and job description
- Downloadable job description document per posting
- Online application submission form linked to each posting

Staff Management

- Designated HR or administrative staff can create, edit, publish, unpublish, and archive vacancy postings
- Document upload per posting
- Automatic expiry based on closing date, or manual unpublish
- View and download submitted applications per vacancy

4.6 Data Migration

The vendor shall be responsible for the migration of all existing content and application data from the current WordPress platform to the new system. This includes:

- All existing loan application records and associated documents
- All existing foreclosure listings, images, and documents
- All existing published content (news, pages, downloadable documents)
- Existing staff vacancy records

The vendor must provide a migration plan prior to commencement. All migrated data must be verified against the source system before go-live sign-off. DFC will conduct a formal data validation exercise before accepting the migration.

A URL redirect mapping must be provided to preserve existing search engine rankings and prevent broken links.

5. Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)

The system must implement configurable role-based access control. A minimum of five roles are required. Access must follow the principle of least privilege. Branch-level data segregation must be enforced where applicable — users must only see applications and data associated with their assigned branch, unless their role grants broader access.

Permission	Branch Staff	Supervisor	Agent	Content Staff	Admin
View own branch applications	✓	✓	—	—	✓
View all branch applications	—	✓	—	—	✓
View assigned applications only	—	—	✓	—	✓
Edit / update application data	✓	—	—	—	✓
Upload documents to application	✓	—	—	—	✓
Add internal notes	✓	✓	✓	—	✓
Generate application package	✓	—	—	—	✓
Forward package to supervisor	✓	—	—	—	✓
Assign application to agent	—	✓	—	—	✓
Update status (own role actions)	✓	✓	✓	—	✓
Manage foreclosure listings	—	—	—	✓	✓
Manage vacancy postings	—	—	—	✓	✓
User and role management	—	—	—	—	✓

Branch configuration	—	—	—	—	✓
View audit logs	—	✓	—	—	✓

The RBAC matrix above is indicative. The final permissions model shall be validated and confirmed during the inception workshop.

6. Technical Scope

6.1 Architecture Requirements

- The solution must be built on a modern web-development framework. The bidder must justify their framework choice in the technical proposal.
- The system must follow an MVC (Model-View-Controller) architectural pattern with clear separation of presentation, business logic, and data persistence layers.
- Database: MySQL 8.0+ or PostgreSQL 14+.
- File storage must be implemented securely.
- The application must be containerisation-ready. Docker-based local development setup with documentation is required.
- No proprietary platform, tool, or third-party dependency that restricts transfer of ownership or access to DFC may be used.
- All environment configuration must be externalised (environment variables). No credentials or environment-specific values may be hardcoded.
- Full deployment documentation must be provided for DFC's internal server environment.

6.2 Usability Requirements

- Responsive design is mandatory across desktop, tablet, and mobile.
- Browser support: latest two versions of Chrome, Edge, Safari, and Firefox.
- Accessibility: WCAG 2.1 AA compliance is the target standard.
- Clear, consistent navigation with logical information hierarchy.
- Effective error messages that guide users without exposing system internals.

6.3 Security Requirements

Given the nature of DFC's operations as a financial institution handling sensitive personal and financial data, the following security standards are mandatory:

Requirement	Standard / Implementation Detail
HTTPS Enforcement	TLS 1.2 or higher required across all pages. HTTP requests must redirect to HTTPS.
CSRF Protection	Anti-CSRF tokens on all state-changing forms and requests.
SQL Injection Prevention	Parameterised queries and prepared statements throughout. ORM usage encouraged.
XSS Mitigation	All user-supplied output must be escaped. Content Security Policy (CSP) headers required.
File Upload Security	File type validation (whitelist), size limits, virus/malware scanning, and storage outside web root.
Authentication	Secure password hashing (bcrypt or Argon2). Strong password policy enforced.

Session Management	Secure, HttpOnly, SameSite cookie flags. Session timeout after inactivity. Session regeneration on login.
Audit Logging	All application state changes, login events, package generation, and document access logged with user ID, IP address, and timestamp.
Data Encryption at Rest	Sensitive personal and financial data encrypted in the database.
Rate Limiting	Applied to public submission endpoints and authentication endpoints to prevent brute force and abuse.
Error Handling	Custom error pages. No stack traces, system paths, or internal details exposed to end users.
Dependency Management	All third-party libraries to be current, supported versions. No known-vulnerable packages at delivery.

7. Methodology

The vendor shall adopt an Agile/SCRUM-based development methodology. DFC's internal team will actively participate in the process through scheduled touchpoints. The following phases and activities are required as a minimum:

#	Phase	Description
1	Inception Workshop	A structured kickoff workshop with DFC stakeholders to validate requirements, to approve project charter and Scope of works, finalise the RBAC matrix, confirm the application form field list, agree on the application package format, and define the scope of data migration.
2	Requirements Validation	The vendor documents agreed user stories and acceptance criteria for each module. DFC signs off before development begins.
3	Wireframes and Mockups	The vendor produces wireframes for all key pages and workflows. At least three design concept options must be presented for the public website. Mockups to be produced in Figma and reviewed collaboratively.
4	Iterative Sprint Development	Development proceeds in two-week sprints. Each sprint delivers testable functionality. DFC participates in sprint reviews.
5	Sprint Reviews	Every two weeks, a sprint review is held where the vendor demonstrates completed features to DFC. Feedback is incorporated into the next sprint. All sprint artefacts are shared via an agreed project management tool.
6	User Acceptance Testing (UAT)	A formal UAT phase of no less than ten (10) business days is required prior to go-live. DFC staff from each role group will participate. A UAT sign-off document is required before final acceptance.
7	Deployment Preparation	The vendor prepares full deployment documentation for DFC's server environment, conducts a final performance and security review, and supports the deployment of the production environment.
8	Knowledge Transfer	The vendor delivers training sessions for functional users (branch staff, supervisors, content staff) and technical training for DFC's IT team. Training materials, user manuals, and technical documentation must be provided.

All project progress, sprint backlogs, and issue tracking must be maintained in an agreed project management tool (e.g., Jira, Azure DevOps, or equivalent). DFC must be granted ongoing access throughout the project.

8. Deliverables

Deliverable	Description
Approved UI/UX Mockups	Figma mockups for all key pages — public website and internal portal — for desktop and mobile, incorporating DFC feedback through two review rounds.
Public Website	Fully implemented public-facing website covering all sections defined in Section 4.1, deployed and functioning in the production environment.
Internal Staff Portal	Fully implemented staff portal covering loan application intake workflow, branch triage, package generation, supervisor assignment, and agent view as defined in Section 4.2.
Foreclosures Module	Public listing view and staff management backend as defined in Section 4.4.
Staff Vacancies Module	Public listing view and staff management backend as defined in Section 4.5.
Data Migration	Full migration of all existing WordPress content and application data, validated and signed off by DFC prior to go-live.
Source Code Repository	Full transfer of the source code repository with complete version history to DFC.
Database Schema Documentation	Full schema documentation including entity-relationship diagrams and field descriptions.
Deployment Documentation	Step-by-step deployment guide for DFC's internal Linux server environment, including environment configuration reference.
User Manual	End-user documentation for each role group: branch staff, supervisors, agents, content staff, and administrators.
Technical Manual	Developer-facing documentation covering system architecture, code structure, configuration, background jobs, and maintenance procedures.
Training Sessions	Functional training for end users; technical training for DFC IT staff. Session recordings and materials to be provided.
UAT Sign-off Report	Formal report documenting UAT results, issues raised, resolutions, and DFC acceptance sign-off.
Warranty Contract	Signed warranty agreement covering a six-month post-acceptance warranty period.
Redirect Mapping	Complete URL redirect map from legacy WordPress URLs to new system URLs to preserve SEO and prevent broken links.

All intellectual property, source code, documentation, and materials produced as part of this engagement shall be the exclusive property of the Development Finance Corporation.

9. Warranty Period

A six (6) month warranty period shall commence on the date of final acceptance. During this period, the vendor is required to resolve defects in the delivered functionality at no additional cost to DFC. The warranty does not cover change requests or new features.

Severity	Definition	Required Response Time
Critical	Issues significantly impacting functionality, security, or data integrity affecting a broad user base or core workflows.	Acknowledge within 4 hours. Resolution plan within 8 hours.
Medium	Issues with a noticeable impact on specific functions or user experience but not posing an immediate operational threat.	Acknowledge and begin triage within 12 hours.
Minor	Non-urgent cosmetic or functional issues that do not critically affect operations.	Acknowledge within 24 hours. Resolution in next scheduled sprint or release.

10. Support and Maintenance

Following the six-month warranty period, an optional post-warranty support arrangement may be proposed by the vendor. However, the system must be fully operable and maintainable by DFC's internal IT team without any vendor dependency.

As a minimum, the vendor must ensure the following prior to handover:

- All source code is cleanly documented and version controlled.
- All environment configuration is externalised and documented.
- DFC IT staff are trained and capable of deploying updates, running migrations, and managing the queue system.
- No vendor-controlled licence, subscription, or proprietary component is required for the system to continue operating.

Where an optional support contract is proposed, it must include a defined scope of monthly hours, clear escalation procedures, and a minimum one-year initial term with renewal provisions. Any support contract is entirely separate from and does not affect DFC's ability to independently maintain and modify the system.

11. References and Portfolio

Each proposal must include the following:

- At least two (2) references for PHP web applications of comparable scope, preferably in financial services, government, or regulated industries. Each reference must include the organisation name, contact person name, contact email or phone number, a brief description of the system delivered, and the technologies used.
- At least two (2) live portfolio examples or video demonstrations (where the system is private) of back-office workflow or application intake systems previously built and handed over to clients.
- CVs for all proposed project team members, identifying their designated role on this project. Required roles include: Lead Developer, Front-End Developer, Back-End Developer, UX/UI Designer, QA/Tester, and Project Manager or SCRUM Master.
- A brief description of any subcontractors proposed and the scope of their involvement.

12. Proposal Format

All proposal documents must be submitted in PDF format. The complete submission must include the following components:

#	Document	Contents
1	Technical Proposal	Proposed architecture and technical approach, security design, methodology plan with timeline, team structure and CVs, and portfolio references.
2	Financial Proposal	Itemised pricing by module (public website, internal portal, foreclosures module, vacancies module, data migration, QA, documentation, training). All prices in Belize Dollars (BZD) inclusive of applicable taxes.
3	Support Proposal (Optional)	Proposed post-warranty support arrangement including monthly hours, scope, escalation process, and pricing.
4	Project Timeline	Proposed delivery schedule broken down by phase and milestone, with key DFC participation points identified.
5	Portfolio Samples	Links or video demonstrations of at least two prior comparable systems.
6	Team CVs	CVs for all named project team members with roles identified.

The Financial Proposal must be submitted as a separate document in a separate email.

13. Evaluation Process

DFC will employ the “Two-Envelope” evaluation method where the evaluation is conducted in two stages. All technical proposals are evaluated before reviewing cost proposals. Only technical proposals that meet the requirements will be considered in the cost proposal review stage.

Stage 1: Evaluation of Technical Proposals: The Technical Proposals will be evaluated based on the following criteria (with assigned weights):

- Technical Compliance and Architecture
- Security, Data Protection, and Compliance
- Methodology, Project Management, and Delivery Approach
- Bidder’s Experience and Portfolio
- Team Composition and Skills

Only Proposers whose Technical Proposals meet the minimum qualifying score will proceed to the second stage.

Stage 2: Evaluation of Cost Proposals: The Cost Proposals of the technically qualified Bidders will be reviewed and evaluated based on price competitiveness and the reasonableness of the proposed costs.

14. Award Criteria

The contract will be awarded to the Bidder whose proposal is determined to be the most advantageous, considering both the technical merit and the cost proposal

15. Confidentiality

All information submitted by Bidders in response to this RFP will be treated as confidential.

— END OF TENDER DOCUMENT —